



BANK OF AMERICA
CHICAGO MARATHON



PARTICIPANT
GUIDE



20
26

TABLE OF CONTENTS

WELCOME	5
SAFETY & MEDICAL	10
PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION & PARKING	13
ABBOTT HEALTH & FITNESS EXPO	17
RACE DAY: GRANT PARK	21
RACE DAY: START	25
RACE DAY: COURSE	32
RACE DAY: FINISH	36
COMMEMORATE YOUR EXPERIENCE	40
MAPS	44



WELCOME

**CAREY PINKOWSKI**

Executive Race Director
Bank of America
Chicago Marathon

Dear participants,

Welcome to the 48th running of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. Every year, tens of thousands of Bank of America Chicago Marathon participants take the long way from the north end of Grant Park to the south end, traveling through 26.2 miles of Chicago's streets on their journey from the start line to the finish line. From soaring skyscrapers to historic two-flats, from bustling commercial corridors to quiet residential streets, every mile gives participants something new to experience.

As you pass through each of the 29 neighborhoods on your journey, though, you will encounter so much more than architecture and districts. In each of these neighborhoods, you will find the people who make the city what it is: residents cheering from porches, business owners welcoming spectators, volunteers bringing their neighborhood's flavor to the course. Chicago does not simply surround you on your journey. It carries you.

Chicago's neighborhoods define the city's character, and in turn define the Bank of America Chicago Marathon experience. The neighborhoods are the heart of the event, and we are proud to welcome you to the city to get a taste of the vibrancy each neighborhood has to offer. We hope it will inspire you and give you strength as you make your way back to Grant Park.

As we enter the final stretch leading up to race day, we encourage you to read through all the information in this guide as a part of your preparations. The 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon Participant Guide is a step-by-step manual to assist you and your guests throughout race weekend.

On behalf of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon staff, Bank of America, the City of Chicago, our sponsors and volunteers, thank you for joining us. The Bank of America Chicago Marathon is far from being the only marathon in the world, but there is no other marathon in the world that's quite like the Chicago Marathon.

Sincerely,

A large, stylized handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Carey Pinkowski". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a large loop for the 'C' and a long, sweeping underline.

EVENT WEBSITE

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon website (chicagomarathon.com) is a great resource for your pre-race, race day and post-race needs. The website has the most up-to-date participant, event and spectator information.

If you can't find the answer to your question, please contact the event via email at office@chicagomarathon.com.

SCHEDULE OF EVENTS

Thursday, October 8

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo; Packet Pick-up

McCormick Place, North Building, Level 3 - Hall B1

10 a.m. – 6 p.m.

Friday, October 9

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo; Packet Pick-up

McCormick Place, North Building, Level 3 - Hall B1

9 a.m. – 6 p.m.

Saturday, October 10

Abbott Chicago 5K

Start line: Ida B. Wells Drive (between Columbus Drive and Michigan Avenue)

Finish line: Wacker Drive and Adams Street

Race start: 7:30 a.m.

Visit chicago5k.com for more information.

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo; Packet Pick-up

McCormick Place, North Building, Level 3 - Hall B1

9 a.m. – 6 p.m.

Sunday, October 11

Bank of America Chicago Marathon

Grant Park

Men's Professional Wheelchair Start 7:20 a.m.

Women's Professional Wheelchair Start 7:21 a.m.

Handcycle Start 7:23 a.m.

Men's and Women's Professional Start 7:30 a.m.

High Performance Program Start 7:32 a.m.

Wave 1 Start 7:35 a.m.

Wave 2 Start 8:00 a.m.

Wave 3 Start 8:35 a.m.

Spectator access to Grant Park begins 9:30 a.m.

27th Mile Post-Race Party 9:30 a.m. – 4 p.m.

Grant Park, Butler Field

BANK OF AMERICA CHICAGO MARATHON APP, POWERED BY TCS

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon App, Powered by Tata Consultancy Services, is the perfect resource to prepare for the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon. Whether you're running or spectating, the free mobile app includes everything you'll need to be prepared for a great race week experience.



The 2026 official race app features unlimited live race day runner tracking, professional athlete profiles, live broadcast streaming, an interactive course map, participant bib share and more.

Make each mile more meaningful! A donate button will appear for any participants you track that are fundraising through charities using the haku platform. Help runners reach their fundraising goal and donate through the Bank of America Chicago Marathon app!

This year's app also includes fifteen major leaderboards that will allow users to find race leaders across all tracked categories, from the professional athlete field to the open field. Full results of the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon will be available in the app in real time.

The Mobile App is available in the App and Google Play stores.

SHARE YOUR EXPERIENCE

Capture the fun and excitement of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon throughout race weekend. From the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo to the 27th Mile Post-Race Party, various photo opportunities will be available, including getting your picture taken with your official finish time! Post your photos on social media and use #MyChicagoMarathon for a chance to be featured on our event channels. If you haven't joined our social media community, we encourage you to follow us!

Facebook: www.facebook.com/ChicagoMarathon

Instagram: @chimarathon

TikTok: @chicagomarathon

YouTube: www.youtube.com/@ChicagoDistanceSeries

ABBOTT CHICAGO 5K

The Abbott Chicago 5K on Saturday, October 10 is the perfect way for marathoners, friends, family and fans of the sport to experience Chicago and take part in the Bank of America Chicago Marathon weekend. The 3.1-mile course weaves through the heart of downtown Chicago and runs past iconic downtown landmarks.



The race kicks off in Grant Park on Ida B. Wells Drive between Columbus Drive and Michigan Avenue and finishes at Wacker Drive and Adams Street near Willis Tower.

Visit chicago5k.com to learn more.

Look for recycling icons located throughout the guide to learn how you can help us with our sustainability initiatives at this year's event.



Keep an eye out for reusable cups at the Abbott Chicago 5K. Help us reduce waste by placing the blue reusable cups in designated bins throughout the event. The cups collected at the event will be cleaned and used at other events in the future.

BANK OF AMERICA CHICAGO DISTANCE SERIES

The 2026 Bank of America Chicago Distance Series concludes with the 48th running of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon! The Distance Series is made up of Chicago's premier racing portfolio: the Shamrock Shuffle 8K Run, Chicago 13.1 and Chicago Marathon. The three races span the outdoor running season and celebrate the vibrant and diverse nature of our local and global running communities. Individuals who finish all 2026 events will receive a unique Bank of America Chicago Distance Series medal and a guaranteed entry into the 2027 Bank of America Chicago Marathon.



SUSTAINABILITY

Incorporating environmentally and socially responsible practices is an important part of the operational planning and production of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. The Chicago Marathon sustainability program focuses on environmental stewardship, community engagement and outreach, accessibility and innovation.

In 2025, the Council for Responsible Sport, a not-for-profit organization that provides objective, independent verification of the socially and environmentally responsible work of sporting events, recognized the event's continued efforts by renewing the race's Evergreen certification. Responsible Sport-certified events are some of the world's leading examples of responsible sport in action, supporting sustainability and environmental consciousness.



Join the Bank of America Chicago Marathon and environmental advocate Tina Muir for a post-race 3K (1.86 mile) plogging event on Monday, October 12. Plogging is a combination of the Swedish term plocka upp (to pick up) and the English word jog. Learn more at chicagomarathon.com/sustainability-and-social-impact.

LOST & FOUND

Lost and found items will be collected throughout race weekend at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo and in Grant Park on race day. If you are looking for an item that was lost, please go to the nearest information tent for more information or visit chicagomarathon.com/lostandfound to confirm if your item was turned into the event lost and found. Following the event, items can be reclaimed at the Hilton Chicago Grand Tradition Room (enter through the main entrance) from 5:30 p.m. to 7 p.m. on Sunday, October 11 and from 8 a.m. to 3 p.m. on Monday, October 12. Any items unclaimed by Friday, December 4 will no longer be available.

AMERICAN SIGN LANGUAGE SERVICES

American Sign Language services will be available race weekend. Services will be available at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo on Thursday, October 8 from 10 a.m. to 12 p.m., on Friday, October 9 from 9 a.m. to 11 a.m. and 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. and on Saturday, October 10 from 9 a.m. to 11 a.m. and 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. in the Participant Services area of the Expo. In addition, all main stage events will have American Sign Language interpretation.

On race day, services will be at designated locations within Grant Park. Please email office@chicagomarathon.com for more information.

EVENT RULES

The event rules are intended to help produce and direct a large-scale event, to ensure the safety of all participants, to meet the requirements of local government permits and to be compliant with applicable USA Track & Field (USATF) and World Athletics regulations for participant performance records and event liability.

Visit chicagomarathon.com/rules to read the complete event rules.

SAFETY & MEDICAL

Creating a safe environment throughout the race weekend is everyone's responsibility. You can contribute to the overall safety of the event by reviewing and following the information outlined in this section.

EVENT ALERT SYSTEM

The color-coded Event Alert System (EAS) will communicate the status of race conditions leading up to and on race day. EAS levels range from Low (Green) to Moderate (Yellow) to High (Red) to Extreme (Black) based primarily on weather, as well as other conditions.

- Email and website communication during race week will inform you of the current EAS level and provide race weekend preparation tips.
- Updates will be made at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo via public address announcements and color-coded signs.
- On race day, stay tuned to the current EAS level via public address announcements and color-coded signs/flags at the start and finish areas and at each of the 20 aid stations along the course.
- If necessary, additional emergency information will be communicated via email and/or text message.

Familiarize yourself with the Event Alert System prior to race day, remain alert for directions from race officials, announcers and volunteers and take precautions to prepare properly for varying conditions on race day.

ALERT LEVEL	EVENT CONDITIONS	RECOMMENDED ACTIONS
EXTREME	EVENT CANCELLED/EXTREME AND DANGEROUS CONDITIONS	PARTICIPATION STOPPED/ FOLLOW EVENT OFFICIAL INSTRUCTION
HIGH	POTENTIALLY DANGEROUS CONDITIONS	SLOW DOWN/OBSERVE COURSE CHANGES/FOLLOW EVENT OFFICIAL INSTRUCTION/CONSIDER STOPPING
MODERATE	LESS THAN IDEAL CONDITIONS	SLOW DOWN/BE PREPARED FOR WORSENING CONDITIONS
LOW	GOOD CONDITIONS	ENJOY THE EVENT/ BE ALERT

MEDICAL SUPPORT

Medical support is available at 22 on-course locations. Medical tents are located at all 20 aid stations with additional medical tents located between Mile 14 and Mile 15 and in the final mile. Medical tents are indicated by tall, red, blade signs with the medical icon (🚑). Each medical tent has access to ambulance service and is staffed by a team of medical professionals equipped with medical supplies and equipment.

In Grant Park, the Main Medical Tent, Podiatry Tent and Ice Station are located directly beyond the finish line. An additional medical tent is in Grant Park adjacent to the 27th Mile Post-Race Party. For the safety of all participants, only those requiring medical assistance may access the medical facilities. If you feel like you need medical assistance on race day, you are encouraged to seek help from a medical volunteer or to visit a medical tent in Grant Park or on course.

Lend a hand, save a life! Participants, volunteers and event staff are encouraged to watch an instructional [Hands-Only CPR video](#) in advance of race weekend. This training is critical and can be lifesaving.

AMERICAN RED CROSS REUNIFICATION SERVICES

The American Red Cross of Greater Chicago's Reunification Services staff will be on hand in Grant Park to provide information to family and friends regarding participants transported to a local area hospital at the discretion of the medical team. Reunification Services staff can be found in the Information Tents located throughout Grant Park as well as at the American Red Cross Reunification Services area on Jackson Boulevard near the Jackson Medical Tent. Family members may also call 888.659.9877 from 7:30 a.m. to 7 p.m. on race day to speak with a Reunification Services Operator to inquire about a patient. Refer to the course map for locations and inform friends and family of this service in advance of race day.

PARTICIPANT CANCELLATION (CANCELLATION BY YOU)

Even on the best of days, the marathon is a challenging endurance event. All participants should respect the distance and only partake in the event if properly trained and physically prepared to complete the distance. Participants unable to participate in the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon can cancel their entry through Wednesday, October 7 via their participant account. While all event fees (entry, ancillary products, etc.) are non-refundable and will not be applied to a future event, participants who cancel their entry will have access to a guaranteed entry for the 2027 Bank of America Chicago Marathon. Please note, this opportunity is not available to participants who received a guaranteed entry for the 2026 event through the 2025 cancelled entry, charity or tour group applications.

PREGNANCY AND POSTPARTUM POLICY

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon has put into place an exception to our standard event policies to permit deferral for participants who need to cancel their registration due to being pregnant, recently pregnant or postpartum.

In addition to the Pregnancy and Postpartum policy, the event will provide private and semi-private lactation spaces to registered postpartum participants and event attendees throughout race weekend. Continue reading for information specific to the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo and race day in Grant Park. Participants with questions can contact the event by emailing office@chicagomarathon.com.

Visit chicagomarathon.com to learn more about the event's Pregnancy and Postpartum Policy.



PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION & PARKING

Event attendees are strongly encouraged to use public transportation throughout race weekend. If you drive, allow sufficient time for traffic congestion and street closures due to the race.

CHICAGO TRANSIT AUTHORITY

The Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) offers an economical and convenient way to not only get to and from the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo, but also to and from the start and finish line while avoiding road closures and other delays



Visit transitchicago.com for more information.

CTA fare information

The Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) encourages all participants and spectators to purchase CTA fares in advance to avoid waiting in long lines at the airports and on race day.

Ventra card

Purchase a Ventra card for \$5 at Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) station vending machines, participating Ventra retail locations, by calling 1.877.NOW.VENTRA or online at ventrachicago.com. Once your card is purchased, you can register it to have the \$5 charge immediately refunded as transit value to pay for rides. Just tap and board, and full fares and transfers on CTA will be deducted from your card.

- Full fare: \$2.25 (bus); \$2.50 (rail); \$5 (from O'Hare) *
- Full fare transfer: Free
- Reduced fare: \$1.10 (bus); \$1.25 (rail) (applies to children ages 7 to 11 and to customers with a valid RTA reduced Fare Permit)
- Reduced fare transfer: Free

Pay for up to seven full-fare rides at once. Free transfers must occur within two hours of the first ride.

You can also load transit value and passes to your Ventra Card at CTA station vending machines, at participating retail locations, through the Ventra app, online or by phone. Passes offer unlimited rides on CTA buses and trains for a specified period of time and include 1-day: \$5; 3-day: \$15; 7-day: \$20. Passes cannot be shared.

**\$5 O'Hare rate applies to people paying with Ventra Transit Account pay-per-use value.*

Virtual Ventra Cards

Virtual Ventra Cards in Apple Pay and Google Wallet allow registered account holders to pay their fares conveniently through their mobile wallet. Download the Ventra app to add a new Virtual Ventra Card to your iPhone or Apple Watch, or to an Android device with Google Wallet, or to virtualize an existing Ventra Card you already have.

Contactless bankcard or Mobile Pay Apps

Use your own contactless bankcard or mobile phone, watch or other device with Apple Pay, Google Wallet or Samsung Pay to tap and travel on CTA and Pace. Tap your card or phone to pay as you go. Pay for up to 7 full-fare rides at once. Free transfers must occur within two hours of the first ride.

Ventra ticket

Single-ride (\$3) and 1-day (\$5) Ventra tickets are available at CTA station vending machines. These disposable tickets cannot be reloaded. Single-ride Ventra tickets include three rides within 2 hours. One-day tickets include unlimited rides for 24 hours after first use.

Cash fare – CTA buses ONLY

Exact fare (coins and bills accepted). No cash transfers available.

Full fare: \$2.50

Reduced fare: \$1.25 (applies to children ages 7 to 11 and customers with a valid RTA Reduced Fare Permit)

Regional Day Pass

The Regional Day Pass, available only in the Ventra App, includes a Metra Day Pass or Saturday or Sunday Pass plus unlimited rides on CTA and Pace for 24 hours at a discounted price. (Requires registered Ventra card.)

Ventra app

The Ventra app allows you to manage your Ventra account, add transit value or passes to your Ventra Card and buy and use Metra mobile tickets. For more information, visit ventrachicago.com/app.

Visit ventrachicago.com for more information.

METRA TRAIN SERVICE

Participants and spectators are encouraged to take advantage of Metra's \$7 Saturday or Sunday Day Pass, good for unlimited rides on either Saturday or Sunday. In addition, the \$10 Weekend Pass (available on the Ventra app only) is good for unlimited rides on both weekend days. Abbott Health & Fitness Expo attendees are encouraged to take the Metra Electric line to and from the Health & Fitness Expo. Metra Electric provides frequent service between McCormick Place and downtown.

Visit metra.com for more information.

SOUTH SHORE LINE

Participants and spectators are encouraged to take the South Shore Line to the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. The South Shore Line runs from South Bend, Indiana to Chicago with stops along the way.

Park your car at one of the convenient South Shore Line stations and ride in comfort to the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo and to Grant Park on race day. For more information about stations and tickets, visit mysouthshoreline.com or call 219-926-5744.

Visit mysouthshoreline.com for more information.

ABBOTT HEALTH & FITNESS EXPO PARKING

Parking will be available to all Abbott Health & Fitness Expo attendees at McCormick Place Parking Lots A and C for a reduced rate of \$13.



To receive the discounted rate, pick up a parking validation card with a QR code from volunteers at counters located near the entrance and exit of the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo. When paying for parking at the exit kiosk, scan your parking ticket first, then scan the QR code on the validation card to reduce the parking fee from \$27 to \$13 before completing your payment.

Please note, parking is available throughout the McCormick Place campus for \$27. Parking Lots A and C are the only parking lots eligible for the reduced \$13 parking rate. Visit chicagomarathon.com/expoparking for driving directions to McCormick Place Parking Lots A and C.

DIVVY

Gear up for the Bank of America Chicago Marathon with Divvy Bikes! Make your commute easy with Divvy Bikes – Chicago's bike and scooter share system. Event attendees can conveniently rent a bike or scooter from various docking stations around Chicago. Divvy will operate a bike valet (for Divvy bikes only) at Michigan Avenue and Jackson Boulevard to accept bikes upon arrival to Grant Park.

Learn more at divvybikes.com.

BIKE VALET

World Bicycle Relief will provide a free bike valet for participants and volunteers at the southeast corner of Michigan Avenue and Van Buren Street. Bikes may be stored starting at 4 a.m. and must be picked up by 4 p.m. Individuals are encouraged to bring a bike lock in the event the Bike Valet has reached capacity.

DISCOUNTED PARKING AT MILLENNIUM GARAGES

Millennium Garages offers affordable parking options for Bank of America Chicago Marathon attendees at all four convenient underground garages situated beneath Grant Park, Millennium Park and Maggie Daley Park. Purchase parking for race weekend in advance online for a discounted rate. Parking passes are valid at all four garages: Millennium Lakeside, Millennium Park, Grant Park South and Grant Park North. Individuals parking for more than one day can save up to 50% on hotel parking by purchasing Extended Stay Parking in advance. Use promo code MARATHON26 to save 10% on multi-day and daily parking from Monday, October 5 to Friday, October 14. Multi-day parking, available in all four garages, includes unlimited in-and-out access. Contact sales@millenniumgarages.com for any questions.



Please note there will be temporary road closures, but all four garages will be open on race day. Should you have trouble reaching your purchased garage, your pass will be accepted at all four Millennium Garages.

Visit millenniumgarages.com/boamarathon for more information.

RIDESHARE

If you choose to utilize rideshare, allow sufficient time for traffic congestion and street closures due to the race. Participants utilizing rideshare should be dropped off west of Michigan Avenue and south of Ida B. Wells Drive.

STREET CLOSURES

Please be aware that extensive street closures will take place on race day. In addition, no parking zones along the course will be enforced in the early morning hours.

Visit chicagomarathon.com/streetclosures for full street closure information.



ABBOTT HEALTH & FITNESS EXPO

The Abbott Health & Fitness Expo features more than 170 health and fitness industry exhibitors offering Bank of America Chicago Marathon merchandise and the latest in running footwear, apparel, nutrition and technology. The Health & Fitness Expo is free and open to the public.

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo attendees may not bring large bags and/or luggage to the Health & Fitness Expo. We encourage you to plan the time of your visit to the Expo with this in mind. Please note that all attendees will be subject to a security screening upon entering the Health & Fitness Expo.

Visit chicagomarathon.com/expo for more information.

LOCATION

McCormick Place, North Building, Level 3 – Hall B1
2301 S. Martin Luther King Dr.
Chicago, IL 60616

**For driving and parking, use the above address for the best access to the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo. If you are driving, follow the signs for Parking Lot A or C for the most convenient parking location. The publicly listed mailing address for McCormick Place is 2301 S. Lake Shore Drive.*

If you are taking a rideshare service to the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo, we encourage you to enter McCormick Place – East Building as your drop off location.

HOURS

Thursday, October 8	10 a.m. – 6 p.m.
Friday, October 9	9 a.m. – 6 p.m.
Saturday, October 10	9 a.m. – 6 p.m.

For a list of Abbott Health & Fitness Expo exhibitors and speakers, go to chicagomarathon.com/expo.

PARTICIPANT PACKET PICK-UP

Packet Pick-up Ticket

The emailed version of your Packet Pick-up Ticket (whether in mobile or printed form) is your individual proof of entry into the race. You will receive your Packet Pick-up Ticket email to the email address used at the point of registration on Wednesday, September 30, 2026. You must present this, along with one form of photo ID, at the Participant Packet Pick-up area of the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo to receive your participant packet (bib number and timing device), participant bag and Nike running shirt.

Review your Packet Pick-up Ticket for accuracy, including your name, address, age and gender. This information is critical for accurate scoring and posting of results. To update your information, email office@chicagomarathon.com.



The Bank of America Chicago Marathon official Nike participant shirt is made from 100% recycled polyester. In addition to reducing waste, recycled polyester reduces carbon emissions by up to 30% compared to virgin polyester and helps Nike divert an average of 1 billion plastic bottles annually from landfills and waterways.

Participant packet

Your participant packet includes:

- Bib number with attached MYLAPS ThinTag timing device
- Gear check tag
- Complimentary Goose Island or Michelob ULTRA beer ticket to be used at the 27th Mile Post-Race Party (for participants aged 21 and over)

Packet Pick-up instructions

- You must pick up your participant packet and participant bag in person at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo during regularly scheduled hours. These items (participant packets, bags and running shirts) will not be available for pickup on race day and will not be mailed.
- You must pick up your own participant packet and participant bag at the Health & Fitness Expo. Individuals will not be allowed to pick up these items on behalf of others.
- After going through the entrance screening process, you will be directed to the Participant Packet Pick-up area where event staff will assist you at one of the check-in stations.
- To check in, you must present your photo ID (driver's license, state ID, passport, etc.), along with your Packet Pick-up Ticket (whether in mobile or printed form).
- If you don't have a form of ID that matches the name used at the point of registration, please go directly to the Participant Services Booth and event staff will assist you.
- If you misplaced or did not receive a Packet Pick-up Ticket, go directly to the Participant Services Desk where event staff will, upon verification of your registration, provide your Packet Pick-up Ticket.
- Proceed to the Participant Bag Pick-up area to receive your participant bag and Nike running shirt; shirts will be distributed according to the size indicated on your packet. A t-shirt exchange will be available if you would like to switch your shirt for an alternative size based on available t-shirt inventory.



The Bank of America Chicago Marathon has eliminated the use of carpet at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo. By not using carpet at the Health & Fitness Expo, the event is saving 55.04 metric tons of CO₂e, which is equivalent to flying on a commercial airliner from Chicago to London 17 times.

EXHIBITORS

For a list of Abbott Health & Fitness Expo exhibitors, go to chicagomarathon.com/expo.



Stop at the Bank of America Chicago Marathon sustainability activation at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo to learn more about the event's sustainability initiatives and how you can support our sustainability efforts on race day.

ABBOTT HEALTH & FITNESS EXPO MAIN STAGE

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo Main Stage presentations will give you an opportunity to learn more about the course, receive last-minute tips and hear from industry experts and special guests. Visit chicagomarathon.com/expo or the Bank of America Chicago Marathon Mobile App for more information on the Main Stage and to view the presentation schedule.

PACE TEAM

The Pace Team will help you set the pace on race day. Pacers—nearly 100 experienced marathon runners—will run according to the following finish time goals: 2:55, 3:00, 3:05, 3:10, 3:15, 3:20, 3:25, 3:30, 3:35, 3:40, 3:45, 3:50, 3:55, 4:00, 4:10, 4:20, 4:30, 4:40, 4:50, 5:00, 5:15, 5:30, 5:45 and 6:00.

Visit the Pace Team booth at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo for more information. Pacers will be available to talk about the race day plan, how to locate your group within the start corrals and to answer general questions about the pacers.

Pace teams are allocated to specific start corrals, and you are welcome to run with any pace team in your assigned corral. Your start corral assignment may not allow you access to run with a particular pace team.

RESTROOMS

Abbott Health & Fitness Expo attendees will have access to public restrooms through the McCormick Place Complex. Restrooms are accessible, and a limited number of single stall gender neutral restrooms are available near the expo hall.

McCORMICK PLACE PRIVATE MAMAVA LACTATION SUITES

McCormick Place, home to the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo, has three private Mamava Lactation Suites. The private suites, also known as pods, are in the following locations:

- Lakeside Center, Level 2, by the Gift Shop
- South Level 2.5 across from Starbucks
- West Level 1 near the Main Information Desk on Indiana Avenue

The Mamava Suites are available to all Health & Fitness Expo attendees. If you plan to use the space during your time at the Expo, we encourage you to download the Mamava Mobile App in advance to unlock the suite upon your arrival.

BANK OF AMERICA BOOTH

Stop by the Bank of America booth as you enter the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo! Take part in the Bank of America Chicago

Marathon experience, featuring iconic Chicago-inspired landmarks and photo-worthy moments throughout the space. While you're there, check out the charity runner wall, pick up a giveaway and grab a cheer bell to celebrate runners throughout race weekend. Bank of America is proud to support more than 20,000 charity runners who are making a meaningful difference in communities across the country. Give if you can and help support their impact by making a donation at bofa.com/HelpACause.



RACE DAY: GRANT PARK

GRANT PARK PARTICIPANT ENTRANCE SCREENING

Prior to entering Grant Park on race day, you must pass through a designated security and bag screening entrance gate located off Michigan Avenue. Your event-issued bib number must be fastened to your front outer layer of clothing and visible to security personnel to enter Grant Park.

Your arrival time and entrance gate will be determined by your start corral assignment. To help us facilitate a smooth entrance process and reduce the wait time at gates, we ask that you please follow the instructions specific to your starting corral assignment.

Personal bags (backpacks, luggage, etc.) will not be permitted; all participants must use the clear plastic event-issued gear check bag for gear. Personal bags may not be placed inside the event-issued gear check bag. Personal bags placed inside the event-issued gear check bag may be confiscated.

Camelbaks® and any type of hydration backpack or running vest with hydration bladders are not permitted. For the avoidance of doubt, running vests with front pocket carry, fuel belts, handheld water bottles and soft flasks are allowed.



Reuse your participant bag following the race. When you're ready to dispose of the bag, remove the string and take it to a facility in your area that accepts plastic bags for recycling. To find a US drop-off location near you and learn how the material is used to make composite decks, visit [Nextrex.com](https://www.nextrex.com).

GRANT PARK SPECTATOR ENTRANCE SCREENING

Spectators will not have access to the race start and finish areas within Grant Park on race day. These areas will be accessible only to participants displaying their event-issued bib numbers, event staff with proper credentials and ticketed guests (where applicable). Family, friends and individuals who are not registered for the race will not be able to escort runners to the start line or greet runners at the finish line.

We recommend that spectators support runners elsewhere on the course and meet runners after the race in designated areas within Grant Park.

The 27th Mile Post-Race Party and Runner Reunite area of Grant Park will open to spectators at 9:30 a.m. To access this area, spectators must pass through security and bag screening at Entrance Gate #1 (Jackson Drive and Michigan Avenue) or Entrance Gate #4 (Ida B. Wells Drive and Michigan Avenue). An additional entrance gate on Monroe St., east of Michigan Ave. will open to spectators at 10:30 a.m.



Use designated sidewalks and walkways in Grant Park to help preserve the foliage in one of Chicago's best green spaces.

PROHIBITED ITEMS

Anyone entering Grant Park must pass through a security screening prior to entering. Items deemed to be dangerous or inappropriate will be confiscated or denied access at the sole discretion of security personnel.

Prohibited items in Grant Park include, but are not limited to:*

- Large bags (backpacks, suitcases and rolling bags)
- Hard-sided coolers
- Costumes covering the face
- Any non-forming bulky outfits extending beyond the perimeter of the body, props and non-running equipment

- Bicycles
- Pets/animals (except for service animals)
- Alcoholic beverages
- Illegal substances
- Chairs
- Weapons
- Remote controlled aircrafts and drones

Wheeled devices are not permitted other than those used by registered and authorized wheelchair, handcycle and duo team participants. Prohibited wheeled devices include non-registered wheelchairs and handcycles, baby joggers, strollers, skateboards, rollerblades and bicycles. Motorized devices of any kind are prohibited.

Please note, strollers, diaper bags, small backpacks and wheelchairs are permitted by spectators, friends and family within Grant Park after the race has started. These items will be screened by security.

For your safety and the safety of all participants, the use of selfie-sticks, camera mounts, video devices, computers or any similar devices by anyone while participating in the event is prohibited.

Camelbaks® and any type of hydration backpack or running vest with hydration bladders are not permitted. For the avoidance of doubt, running vests with front pocket carry, fuel belts, handheld water bottles and soft flasks are allowed.

Music devices with headphones are permitted for use on the course; however, participants must be alert to their surroundings at all times and must pay attention to important announcements made in Grant Park and along the course. Music devices with headphones are not permitted for use by athletes in the High Performance Division.

**Subject to change.*

INFORMATION TENTS

Information tents will be available throughout Grant Park on race day. Information volunteers will be available to assist participants and spectators with event information, course maps and general event inquiries as well as lost and found items. Information tents will be in the following areas:

- On the east side of Michigan Avenue at 11th Street
- On the east side of Michigan Avenue at Harrison Street
- On the east side of Michigan Avenue at Jackson Drive
- Within the Buckingham Fountain Gear Check facility (participant-only Information Tent)
- Within the 27th Mile Post-Race Party near the Jackson Boulevard entrance
- On westbound Ida B. Wells Drive between Columbus Drive and Congress Circle



Look for Green Team volunteers staffing Zero Waste Stations throughout Grant Park. Participants looking to dispose of any materials can place items on tables for Green Team volunteers to sort into recycling, composting, upcycling or landfill bins.

RACE DAY LACTATION SPACES

Private and semi-private lactation spaces are available to participants on race day. Participants interested in using the spaces will have access to a private or semi-private seating area (chair and table), a water source or a portable hand-washing station and a power source. Spaces will be available in the following locations:

- Pre-race: Private and semi-private space at the Hilton Chicago (720 S. Michigan Avenue)
- On-course: Private and semi-private tented facility on Laflin Street between Adams Street and Jackson Boulevard at Miles 15 and 16
- Post-race: Private and semi-private tented facilities, with access to power and a sink, are provided at the 27th Mile Post-Race Party. Visit the information tent to request access.

Participants interested in using the pre-race space at the Hilton Chicago are asked to email office@chicagomarathon.com for instructions on how to access the space.

Staff will be onsite at each location to assist those interested in using the space(s) on a first-come, first-served basis.

Please note, the event will not store or transport equipment on-course or at the Post-Race Party.

Additional questions about lactation spaces can be directed to office@chicagomarathon.com in advance of the event.

RACE DAY: START

SCHEDULE OF EVENTS

Grant Park opens to runners	5:30 a.m.
Gear check opens	5:30 a.m.
Start corrals open	5:30 a.m.
Wave 1 start corrals close	7:20 a.m.
Men's Professional Wheelchair Start	7:20 a.m.
Women's Professional Wheelchair Start	7:21 a.m.
Handcycle Start	7:23 a.m.
Men's and Women's Professional Start	7:30 a.m.
High Performance Program Start	7:32 a.m.
Wave 1 Start	7:35 a.m.
Wave 2 start corrals close	7:45 a.m.
Wave 2 Start	8:00 a.m.
Wave 3 start corrals close	8:10 a.m.
Wave 3 Start	8:35 a.m.
Grant Park opens to spectators	9:30 a.m.
27th Mile Post-Race Party starts	9:30 a.m.
Gear check closes	4:00 p.m.
27th Mile Post-Race Party ends	4:00 p.m.

BIB NUMBER

Your 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon bib number is a unique identifier. It must be visible and always worn on your outer layer of clothing on race day.

Bib number guidelines:

- Your bib number must be fastened with four (4) pins to the front of your outer layer of clothing and be visible to gain access into Grant Park and your start corral. Pins will be available at Packet Pick-up.
- Your bib must be visible throughout the entirety of the race.
- Do not physically alter (cut, fold or obscure) your bib number in any way.
- Do not decorate your bib with any metal items, as this may cause a malfunction of your bib timing device.
- Do not laminate your bib.
- Pinning your bib directly on top of or underneath a fueling belt or other running pack, especially one containing electronics, may cause a malfunction of your bib timing device.
- Fill out the back of your bib number with your emergency contact and medical information.
- Your bib number is non-transferable and must be worn only by you, the registered participant.
- The sale and/or transfer of your bib number is strictly prohibited and will result in disqualification.
- If your bib is altered or worn improperly, you risk scoring issues such as missed splits and a finish time which can lead to possible disqualification.

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon uses a MYLAPS ThinTag timing device to record your net finish time. The timing device is permanently attached to the back of your bib number. Do not remove the timing device from your bib or fold it in any way. Wearing your bib improperly could result in improper scoring and possible disqualification. Your time will be recorded from the point that you cross the timing mats at the start line until you cross the timing mats at the finish line.

GEAR CHECK

To facilitate a more efficient race experience, the Bank of America Chicago Marathon encourages participants to leave personal items at home and to keep small items such as keys, money or phones with you during the race. If you bring items to the Chicago Marathon that you can't carry with you during the race, you must check them using your event-issued gear check bag at your designated gear check area, which is determined by the color on the top and bottom of your bib: red, blue or orange.

Gear check guidelines:

- Gear check is available to participants only; spectators are not allowed in the gear check area.
- You must use your race-issued gear check bag (your clear plastic participant bag); no other bags will be accepted at gear check. Personal bags may not be placed inside the race-issued gear check bag.
- Remove your gear check tag from your bib number and attach it to your gear check bag. We also encourage you to write your bib number on the space provided on your gear check bag in the event your gear check tag falls off.
- Do not check valuable items such as wallets, money, jewelry, cell phones, cameras, music or electronic devices, etc.; the event is not responsible for lost, stolen or damaged items.
- You must show your bib number when dropping off and picking up your gear. To support a more efficient return of your bag, please present your gear check claim ticket, located on your bib, when picking up your gear.
- Loose articles of clothing or other personal items that are not placed in your clear plastic event-issued gear check bag will not be accepted at gear check.
- All bags must be picked up by 4 p.m. on race day. Bags that are not picked up by 4 p.m. will be taken to Grand Tradition Room, located near the Michigan Avenue entrance of the Hilton Chicago (720 S. Michigan Avenue) where they can be picked up in person from 5:30 to 7 p.m.
- If you need to pick up your bag at the Hilton Chicago following the race, please visit chicagomarathon.com/lostandfound to confirm that your bag is available for pickup.
- Any items unclaimed by Friday, December 4 will no longer be available.

WAVE START AND START CORRALS

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon features a wave start and start corral process. Your start wave is determined by your start corral assignment: Wheelchair, High Performance, A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, J, K, L, M or N. Your start corral assignment is indicated on your Packet Pick-up Ticket and the letter included on your event-issued bib number.

Start corral guidelines:

- Your bib number corresponds with your start corral assignment (Wheelchair, High Performance, A, B, C, D, E, F, G, H, J, K, L, M or N).
- Your bib number must be fastened to the front of your running attire and be visible to gain access to your start corral.
- You will be granted access to your assigned start corral only.
- Wave 1 Start Corrals (High Performance, A, B, C, D and E) will close at 7:20 a.m.
- Wave 2 Start Corrals (F, G, H and J) will close at 7:45 a.m.
- Wave 3 Start Corrals (K, L, M and N) will close at 8:10 a.m.
- Family and friends will not be allowed to accompany participants to the start area.

WAVE 1

Start corrals: A, B, C, D and E

Suggested arrival time: 5:30 a.m.

Suggested entrance gates

Start Corral A: Entrance Gate #1 – Jackson

Start Corral B: Entrance Gate #1 – Jackson

Start Corral C: Entrance Gate #3 – Van Buren

Start Corral D: Entrance Gate #4 – Ida B. Wells

Start Corral E: Entrance Gate #5 – Ida B. Wells

Start corrals close: 7:20 a.m.

If you are not in your start corral by 7:20 a.m., you must start at the back of your assigned wave.

Race start: 7:35 a.m.



WAVE 2

Start corrals: F, G, H and J

Suggested arrival time: 6 a.m.

Suggested entrance gates

Start Corral F: Entrance Gate #1 – Jackson

Start Corral G: Entrance Gate #3 – Van Buren

Start Corral H: Entrance Gate #2 – Van Buren

Start Corral J: Entrance Gate #4 – Ida B. Wells

Start corrals close: 7:45 a.m.

If you are not in your start corral by 7:45 a.m., you must start at the back of your assigned wave.

Race start: 8 a.m.



WAVE 3

Start corrals: K, L, M and N

Suggested arrival time: 6:30 a.m.

Suggested entrance gates

Start Corral K: Entrance Gate #5 – Ida B. Wells

Start Corral L: Entrance Gate #2 – Van Buren

Start Corral M: Entrance Gate #4 – Ida B. Wells

Start Corral N: Entrance Gate #3 – Van Buren

Start corrals close: 8:10 a.m.

If you are not in your start corral by 8:10 a.m., you must start at the back of your assigned wave.

Race start: 8:35 a.m.



START LINE PROCEDURES

It will take approximately 20 to 25 minutes for the final participant from each wave to cross the start line. Please adhere to your assigned wave and the start time. Remember that your official time will not begin until you cross the timing mat at the start line. Follow directions from race officials and volunteers at all times for a safe and orderly start to the race.

We encourage you to pay attention to the forecast in the days leading up to the event and refrain from bringing excess clothing to the start line. If you bring extra clothing you plan to discard, please place it in designated clothing collection zones identified by signage near and within the start corrals.



Following the start of the race, Green Team Volunteers will collect discarded clothing from the designated clothing collection zones. All clothing collected at the start is donated to Illinois AMVETS and The Salvation Army.

PARTICIPANT CHANGING FACILITIES

For your convenience, individual gender-neutral changing stalls are available near the gear check areas in Grant Park after the race. Changing stalls will not be available before the race begins.

PRE-RACE FLUIDS AND SUPPLIES

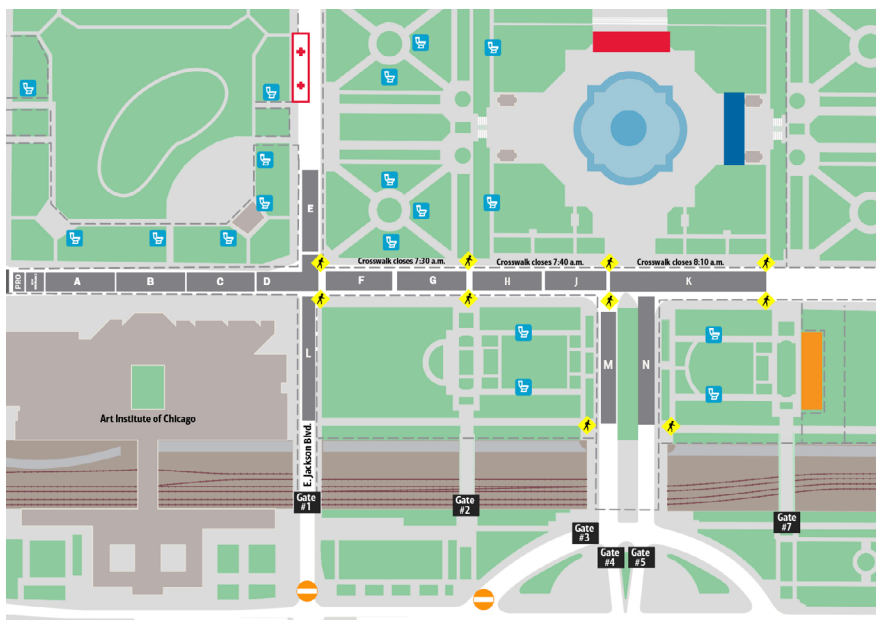
Gatorade Endurance Formula (lemon-lime flavor) and water will be available prior to the race at start hydration areas. Other supplies such as Band-Aids, safety pins and skin lubricant will be available at the Information/Supply tents near your assigned gear check. Refer to the Grant Park map for specific locations.



Refill your water cups at the water filling stations located at each start hydration area. When finished, be sure to compost your water and Gatorade cups at the nearest Zero Waste Station.

TOILET FACILITIES

Standard and ADA portable restrooms will be positioned north and south of Ida B. Wells Drive, north of Buckingham Fountain and near Wave 1 corrals after the initial corral entrance gates. There will also be banks of urinal-only toilets in Grant Park near Wave 1 corrals. All restroom facilities are indicated by signs. If you need to use a restroom after you have entered your corral, you may exit your corral to use the restroom, provided you return before the time your corral closes.



Many participants will want to use the restrooms at the same time, which can lead to extended wait times. Please account for this when planning your arrival to Grant Park. If there is a line, we encourage you to walk to the next set of portable restrooms nearby or ask an information team volunteer for directions to the next closest set of portable restrooms.

RACE DAY: COURSE

AID STATIONS

20 aid stations are located along the course approximately one to two miles apart. Each aid station consists of the following amenities in this order:

- Medical Tent with access to a Runner Transport vehicle
- Standard and ADA portable restrooms
- Gatorade Endurance Formula (lemon-lime flavor)
- Public address announcer
- Water

Maurten is the Official Hydrogel Sports Fuel for the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. Out on course, runners can grab a caffeinated or non-caffeinated Gel 100, both containing 25 grams of carbohydrates, from the Hydrogel Fuel Depots at Mile 12.4 (near Aid Station 9) and at Mile 18.1 (near Aid Station 14). Maurten Gels use patented Hydrogel Technology that enables smooth transportation of carbohydrates through the stomach during high-intensity exercise, reducing discomfort.

Please only take one gel per station to ensure participants behind you have access to gels.

Aid Stations 16-18 (Miles 20.2-23) will offer Chiquita Bananas.



The Bank of America Chicago Marathon course features four Culligan Water Refill Stations, located immediately prior to Aid Station 4 (Mile 5.7), Aid Station 7 (Mile 10.1), Aid Station 12 (Mile 15.7) and Aid Station 16 (Mile 20.3), along the course. Culligan Water Refill Stations give participants the opportunity to refill their approved self-carried hydration gear with Culligan-filtered water. Participants will refill their own hydration gear within the station.

Please note, approved self-carried hydration gear includes running vests with front pocket carry, fuel belts, handheld water bottles and soft flasks. Backpacks and running vests with hydration bladders are not permitted. More information on approved hydration gear is available at chicagomarathon.com/hydration.

Don't miss the Biofreeze Pain Relief Zone around Mile 21.2 (Cermak Road and Archer Avenue) where the Biofreeze Cooling Crew will be armed with Biofreeze spray to help Cool the Pain to get participants across the finish line.

Familiarize yourself with the locations and offerings at each aid station and prepare for slower traffic in these areas. The aid stations are approximately two city blocks in length. Tables with Gatorade Endurance Formula (lemon-lime flavor) and water line both sides of the street. Continue moving through the aid station if the first tables are too crowded to obtain fluids.

Aid station	Location	Mile	Items*
1	Dearborn St. between Washington St. and Monroe St..	1.6	G, W
2	LaSalle St. between Ohio St. and Huron St.	3.25	G, W
3	Stockton Dr. north of LaSalle St.	5.05	G, W
4	Cannon Dr. north of Fullerton Pkwy.	5.75	G, W
5	Inner Lake Shore Dr. between Cornelia Ave. and Addison St.	7.3	G, W
6	Broadway between Aldine Ave. and Belmont Ave.	8.8	G, W
7	Clark St. between Belden Ave. and Webster St.	10.1	G, W
8	Wells St. between North Ave. and Burton Pl.	11.5	G, W

Aid station	Location	Mile	Items*
9	Wells St. between Grand Ave. and Hubbard St.	12.6	G, W, MG
10	Adams St. between Canal St. and Desplaines St.	13.6	G, W,
11	Adams St. between Racine Ave. and Throop St.	14.6	G, W
12	Jackson Blvd. between Damen Ave. and Ogden Ave.	15.7	G, W
13	Jackson Blvd. between Sangamon St. and Green St.	16.9	G, W
14	Taylor St. between Racine Ave. and Loomis St.	18	G, W, MG
15	18th St. between Blue Island Ave. and Throop St.	19.2	G, W,
16	Canalport Ave. between Halsted St. and Cermak Rd.	20.2	G, W, B
17	Michigan Ave. between 26th St. and 28th St.	22.3	G, W, B
18	Michigan Ave. between 33rd St. and 35th St.	23.04	G, W, B
19	Michigan Ave. between 26th St. and 25th St.	24.5	G, W
20	Michigan Ave. between 18th St. and 16th St.	25.2	G, W

*G = Gatorade Endurance Formula (lemon-lime flavor); W = Water; MG= Maurten Gels; B = Chiquita Bananas



Chiquita proudly fuels Bank of America Chicago Marathon runners with fresh, high-quality bananas that deliver natural energy and great taste. This year, the bananas will feature limited-edition compostable stickers as part of our continued commitment to sustainability.

COURSE TIME LIMIT

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon has a course time limit of 6 hours and 30 minutes, a 15-minute mile pace. An event vehicle following the last starter will maintain a 15-minute mile pace indicating to event and traffic safety personnel when it is time to re-open the course to vehicular traffic. If the event end vehicle passes you, you must move to the sidewalk. You must maintain a 15-minute per mile pace (approximately) or faster to receive full on-course support from aid stations and traffic safety personnel.

Participants who do not maintain a 15-minute per mile pace (approximately) will be required to move to the sidewalk as streets re-open to vehicular traffic. The course is monitored to enforce policies ensuring participant and spectator safety. This includes monitoring from event officials and in some areas the use of photography. Photographic documentation may be used to support enforcement actions, such as disqualification, for participants who do not follow direction from event officials and traffic safety personnel.

If you finish after 3:30 p.m., you will be directed to an area immediately west of the finish line to collect runner refreshment items and a finisher medal. If you checked gear, your gear check bag will either be available in this area or at the Hilton Chicago Grand Tradition Room (enter through the main entrance) from 5:30 p.m. to 7 p.m. on Sunday, October 11 and from 8 a.m. to 3 p.m. on Monday, October 12. Please note that spectators will be directed to this area beginning at 3:30 p.m. If you anticipate finishing after 3:30 p.m. and will have spectators to meet after the race, direct them to this location rather than the 27th Mile Post-Race Party. Spectators can enter this location at 11th Street and Michigan Avenue.

RUNNER TRANSPORT SERVICE

Runner Transport vehicles provide non-emergency transportation from all 20 aid stations back to Grant Park if a participant is unable to complete the race. Runner Transport signs and volunteers wearing green vests will be located at each on-course medical tent.

TIMING CHECKPOINTS, CLOCKS & MILE MARKERS

Timing checkpoints are positioned at the start line, at each 5K, at the halfway point (13.1 miles), at Miles 20-25, at Mile 25.2 and at the finish line. Your timing device will register split times at each of these checkpoints.

Digital clocks are positioned at the start line, every 5K on the course and at the finish line to provide the elapsed race time. Kilometer markers are positioned at each 5K to assist you in locating the clocks. Signage will note each mile and kilometer marker on the course. Digital clocks at the finish line will display the elapsed race time of each wave, with the elapsed race time beginning at the start of each wave. Your individual race time may differ depending on when you cross the official start line.

Distance markers on the course reflect the official distance of the race. The distance that displays on your personal device, such as a watch or phone, may differ.



Kia all-electric EV9 lead vehicles kicked off the start of all events in the Bank of America Chicago Distance Series last year, helping to reduce the overall emissions of the events we produce. Look for Kia again this year as part of our continued focus

on reducing our impact on the planet. Chicagoland and Northwest Indiana Kia retailers are proud to support the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon, where you can see the vehicles race weekend or visit your local Kia retailer.



BANK OF AMERICA CHEER ZONES

Join Bank of America on race morning to cheer on runners at one of the Bank of America Cheer Zones along the racecourse! Visit

N. Wacker Drive in front of the Bank of America Tower (Mile 13) or the final stretch at Michigan Avenue and Roosevelt Road (Mile 26). Enjoy live entertainment, pick up cheer items and help create an unforgettable race day experience for runners as they make their way to the finish line.



PROHIBITED DEVICES ON COURSE

Wheeled devices are not permitted on the Bank of America Chicago Marathon course by anyone other than registered and authorized wheelchair, handcycle and duo team participants. Prohibited wheeled devices include non-registered wheelchairs and handcycles, baby joggers, strollers, skateboards, rollerblades and bicycles. Motorized devices of any kind are prohibited.

For your safety and the safety of all participants, the use of selfie-sticks, camera mounts, video devices, computers or any similar devices by anyone while participating in the event is prohibited.

Backpacks and running vests with hydration bladders are not permitted. For the avoidance of doubt, self-carried hydration gear includes running vests with front pocket carry, fuel belts, handheld water bottles and soft flasks are allowed.

Music devices with headphones are permitted for use on the course; however, participants must be alert to their surroundings at all times and must pay attention to important announcements made in Grant Park and along the course. Music devices with headphones are not permitted for use by athletes in the High Performance Division.

Additional prohibited items on the course route include, but are not limited to: large bags (backpacks, suitcases and rolling bags), hard-sided coolers, costumes covering the full face (except face coverings if mandated by governmental order), any non-forming bulky outfits extending beyond the perimeter of the body, props and non-running equipment, pets/animals (except for service animals that are trained to perform specific work or tasks for a person with a disability), alcoholic beverages, illegal substances, chairs, weapons, remote controlled aircrafts and drones.

Please note, any items deemed to be dangerous or inappropriate will be confiscated at the sole discretion of security personnel.

RACE DAY: FINISH

FINISH LINE PROCEDURES

For the convenience and safety of all participants, please continue moving through the finish area. No stopping or loitering is allowed at or beyond the finish line, including for photos. Participants who sit or lie down in the finish area will be immediately transferred to the medical tent and will not be released until cleared by medical staff. Volunteers will be positioned just beyond the finish line within the runner recovery area to distribute Heatsheets™ and finisher medals. Once you exit the finish area, there is no re-entry.



Heatsheets collected race day will be turned into Trex boards (a wood-alternative material) as part of the Heatsheets “Blankets to Boards” program.

RUNNER REFRESHMENT

Refreshments will be available beyond the finish line within the Runner Refreshment area, including Gatorade Endurance Formula (lemon-lime flavor), a Culligan aluminum water bottle, Chiquita Bananas, Chocolate MUSCLE MILK Pro Protein Shake and a variety of other snacks. Please only take one of each item to ensure there is enough for all participants. For participants aged 21 and over, Goose Island Beer Co. will be serving a 312 BEER to Bank of America Chicago Marathon finishers. Please note, beer cans will be opened by volunteers at the finish line.



Following the race, look for Michigan Apples in the Runner Refreshment area. Refuel your body with a locally sourced and healthy treat.

BANK OF AMERICA CHICAGO DISTANCE SERIES MEDALS

Bank of America Chicago Distance Series medals will be distributed within the Runner Refreshment area in tents located on participants' right side immediately before the exit to runner refresh. Please note, only Bank of America Chicago Distance Series finishers are entitled to these medals.

Bank of America Chicago Distance Series finishers will also receive a guaranteed entry to the 2027 Bank of America Chicago Marathon. Finishers can expect an email with entry information during the application period for the 2027 race.

ABBOTT WORLD MARATHON MAJORS SIX STAR MEDALS

Abbott World Marathon Majors Six Star medals will be distributed within the Runner Refreshment area in tents located on participants' right side immediately before the exit to runner refresh. Please note, only Abbott World Marathon Major Six Star finishers are entitled to these medals.

Any participant completing their Six Star journey at the Bank of America Chicago Marathon must have a complete profile on the Abbott World Marathon Majors website, claim all previous results and register with Abbott World Marathon Majors no later than Sunday, September 27. Participants who do not complete these steps will not receive their medal at the finish line of the Chicago Marathon.

RUNNER REUNITE

Connect with friends and family after the race at Runner Reunite. Red alphabetical towers (A-Z) will be staged in Butler Field within the 27th Mile Post-Race Party to facilitate meeting locations by last name. When making plans to reunite with your family and friends, we encourage you to identify a specific letter to meet your friends and family by post-race. Please communicate to your family and friends that they should meet you within Butler Field and not congregate around participant entry points into the 27th Mile Post-Race Party to avoid crowding. Factor in the time it will take you to navigate through the finish area and collect your bag from gear check. We estimate getting from the finish to the Post-Race Party can take 30 minutes or longer. Devise a backup plan if you cannot locate your party within Grant Park.



Zero Waste Stations in Grant Park and all on-course aid stations will collect organic waste, including water cups, Gatorade Endurance cups, banana peels and other food scraps, which will be turned into nutrient-rich soil and donated to local community gardens.

27TH MILE POST-RACE PARTY

Celebrate your accomplishment at the 27th Mile Post-Race Party in Butler Field, near the start line at Columbus Drive and Jackson Drive. The outdoor celebration will feature music from a Chicago-based DJ and food and beverages available for purchase. Participants aged 21 and over (photo ID required) can redeem the tear-off portion of their bib number for one Goose Island 312 BEER, Goose IPA and Michelob ULTRA Superior Light Beer..



The 27th Mile Post-Race Party is open to the public from 9:30 a.m. to 4 p.m. Beer tickets will be for sale from 9:30 a.m. to 3 p.m. and can be redeemed until 3:30 p.m.



The Bank of America Chicago Marathon partners with Culligan International to make a real difference by advancing sustainable race day hydration for runners and spectators alike. As a result, everyone has access to cleaner, better tasting filtered water and the event reduces its reliance on single use plastic. As participants cross the finish line, they receive a refillable aluminum Culligan water bottle which they are encouraged to reuse or recycle, furthering the sustainable impact beyond race day.

Building on our shared commitments, this year we will pilot four structured refill stations on course for runners to access during the race with personal water vessels. The initiative aims to ensure high-quality water for all while reducing waste and creating new, sustainable behaviors. An extension of our long term partnership with Culligan, this pilot will help evolve best practices around hydration at endurance race events, inclusive of participants bringing their own bottles or flasks. At the Bank of America Chicago Marathon, Culligan makes it easier to hydrate responsibly and support more sustainable experiences for people and the planet.

POST-RACE CELEBRATIONS WITH GOOSE ISLAND BEER CO.

After the 27th Mile Post-Race Party, continue the celebration at one of the five Goose Island Post-Race Participant Celebrations throughout the city. Be one of the first three hundred and twelve runners to arrive wearing a 2026 finisher medal, at any of the five locations, and the first 312 BEER is on the house!

This year's Goose Island post-race participant celebrations will take place at:

Lizzie McNeill's

400 N. McClurg Ct.
Chicago, IL 60611

Goose Island Salt Shed Pub

1221 W. Blackhawk St.
Chicago, IL 60642

Millennium Hall

11 N. Michigan Ave.
Chicago, IL 60602

The Scout Waterhouse + Kitchen

1419 N. Wells St.
Chicago, IL 60610

Goose Island Taproom

1800 W. Fulton St.
Chicago, IL 60612

RACE RESULTS

Unofficial race results will be available at chicagomarathon.com following the race. The Bank of America Chicago Marathon App, Powered by Tata Consultancy Services features unlimited live race day runner tracking. We encourage you and your friends and family to download the mobile app from the App or Google Play stores in advance of race day.

Once race results are deemed official, all official finishers will be emailed a link to download their digital finisher's certificate.

All official finishers will receive a digital copy of the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon results book after the event with a complete listing of results, race day coverage and photos. A printed version of the results book is available for purchase in your participant account.

ABBOTT WORLD MARATHON MAJORS SIX STAR HOPEFULS

The Bank of America Chicago Marathon is a member of the Abbott World Marathon Majors, the family of the eight greatest marathons in the world. After you cross the Chicago Marathon finish line you will have taken one more step on your journey to become a Six Star Finisher. Visit abbottwmm.com to learn more about the Six Star Finisher program and to claim your 2026 Chicago star.



AGE DIVISIONS AND AWARDS

Personalized engraved finisher medals will be awarded to the top finishers in each age division listed below. Age group medals will be mailed to the winners following the official verification of all race results.

Men, Women and Non-binary: 16-19, 20-24, 25-29, 30-34, 35-39, 40-44, 45-49, 50-54, 55-59, 60-64, 65-69, 70-74, 75-79, 80 & over.



**COMMEMORATE
YOUR
EXPERIENCE**

OFFICIAL NIKE MERCHANDISE

Commemorate your Bank of America Chicago Marathon journey with official merchandise by Nike. The official merchandise collection includes both performance running and lifestyle apparel and can be purchased online, in-store at Nike Chicago, Heartbreak Running, Chicago Fleet Feet locations or at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo. First access is available to Nike Members on Thursday, October 1. Sign up at nike.com/membership.



Participants are encouraged to purchase merchandise in advance of race weekend. Shipping or in-store pickup is available for nike.com purchases. Please note, official merchandise is limited.

For a complete list of retail locations visit nike.com/chicago. Official finisher merchandise will be available on Saturday, October 10 only at Nike Chicago, nike.com, and in the Nike App.

COMMEMORATIVE MERCHANDISE

Commemorative merchandise for the 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon, including glassware, magnets and more will be sold at the Abbott Health & Fitness Expo.

RACE PHOTOS FROM MARATHONFOTO

MarathonFoto is proud to be the official photographer of the Bank of America Chicago Marathon. This year, MarathonFoto has over 120 photographers strategically positioned at 20 different locations along the course and as you cross the finish line. Participants can also look forward to a customized video commemorating their achievement and highlighting the iconic Chicago Marathon course. Keep an eye out for an email after the race when your photos are online, or head to Marathonfoto.com to be the first to share your big finish.



Visit marathonfoto.com for more information.

CITY SCENTS FLORAL & HOME

City Scents, located in the Streeterville neighborhood of downtown Chicago at 209 East Ohio Street, just two blocks east of Michigan Avenue, is offering ‘Good Luck!’ and ‘Congratulations!’ floral arrangements for race participants and loved ones. Purchase online or on race day in Grant Park at four locations. City Scents also delivers to hotels and residences around Chicago, including the surrounding suburbs. Go to the Marathon Store page at chicagomarathon.com, visit cityscents.com or call 312.836.0211 for more information.



Refer to the Grant Park map for locations.

PERSONALIZE YOUR FINISHER MEDAL WITH AN itab

The 2026 Bank of America Chicago Marathon finisher medals are designed to be personalized with an itab. The itab is a small plate engraved with your name and official finish time which affixes to the designated area on the back of the finisher medal. Personalized itabs will be mailed following the event.



make it
personal

Go to the marathon store page at chicagomarathon.com to purchase a 2026 itab.

THANK YOU TO OUR SPONSORS

BANK OF AMERICA 



 ABBOTT

tcs TATA
CONSULTANCY
SERVICES

 Advocate
Health Care®



BIOFREEZE®




MAURTEN



Culligan™



**THE 670
SCORE**
CHICAGO SPORTSRADIO

93XRT
CHICAGO'S FINEST ROCK

Athletico
Blue Plate
Chiquita
City Scents
Dick's Sporting Goods
Fleet Feet
HydraPak
Intelligentsia
Jewel-Osco
Kindling Snacks
McDonald's
MadeGood
Meta
Michelob Ultra
Michigan Apple Committee

Muscle Milk
Runners World
Shokz
Stan's Donuts & Coffee
Stryker
Sumitomo Electric
Sunki
That's It.
The Scout Waterhouse + Kitchen
UGREEN
White Claw
WillScot
Yakult
Zel Hotels
Zulu

What would
you like the
power to do?®

**FIND A RUNNER.
HELP A CAUSE.**



A marathon is measured in miles, but the reasons people run go far beyond the finish line.

For the thousands of athletes taking on the Bank of America Chicago Marathon, it's a chance to turn their personal passions into meaningful impact. They're running for the causes and people who shaped them, and together these runners are supporting more than 217 nonprofits across Chicagoland and beyond.

Bank of America is proud to support the athletes who dedicate their journey to creating change and everyone who dares to ask, "What would you like the power to do?"



**Find a runner.
Help a cause. Give if you can.**



When you scan the QR feature certain information is collected from your mobile device for business purposes. The opinions are those of the participants. Any reference to charitable organizations is for informational purposes only and does not imply an endorsement or solicitation by Bank of America Corporation or authorization to promote its services. Any prospective donor should conduct an independent review of the charitable organization before donating.
©2026 Bank of America Corporation.



October 11, 2026
chicagomarathon.com



Mile marker



Kilometer marker



Culligan Water Refill Station



Aid station
Contains medical, toilets, water
Gatorade Endurance Formula



Medical



Marathon course



Maurten Hydrogel
Fuel Depot



Biofreeze Pain Relief Zone



Bank of America
Cheer Zone



Charity block party

Course subject to change





BANK OF AMERICA
CHICAGO MARATHON

Grant Park Start/finish map

October 11, 2026

- 1 Para Athletics Start Area
- 2 Start Stage
- 3 Beer Serving
- 4 Beer Tickets
- 5 Concessions
- 6 City Scents
- 7 Post-Race Party Stage
- 8 Beer Tickets
- 9 Concessions
- 10 Beer Serving
- 11 High Performance Program

Course route

Road closed to vehicle traffic

Toilets

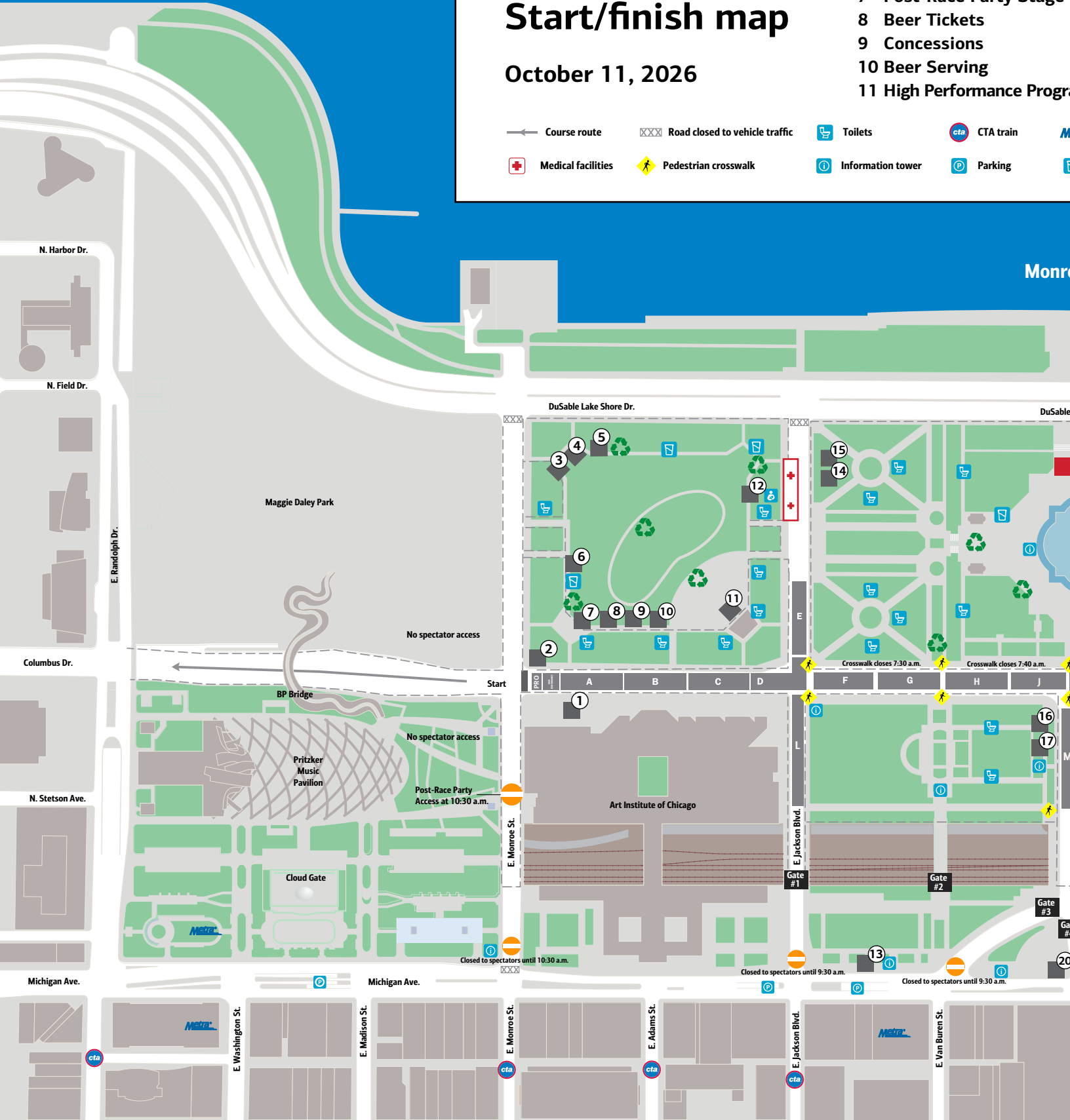
CTA train

Medical facilities

Pedestrian crosswalk

Information tower

Parking



12 Information Tent

13 Information Tent

14 Pace Team Tent

15 American Red Cross

16 City Scents

17 Information Tent

18 Red Gear Check

19 Information Tent

20 City Scents

21 Para Athletics Finish Area

22 Blue Gear Check

23 Orange Gear Check

24 Information Tent

25 Harrison Volunteer Compound

26 Skyline Hospitality

27 Premier Runner Program Tent

28 Finish Line Lounge

29 Final Finisher Area

30 Information Tent

31 City Scents

32 Finish Line Viewing Access (Ticketed)

Metra train

Hydration

Spectator entrance

No entry

Zero waste station

Lactation space

Map subject to change

oe Harbor

Lake Shore Dr.

DuSable Lake Shore Dr.

Museum Campus

Crosswalk closes 8:10 a.m.

Finish

No spectator access

No spectator access

E. Indiana Ave.

Michigan Ave.

Michigan Ave.

Bank of America
Cheer Zone

E. Ida B. Wells Dr.

E. Harrison St.

E. Balbo Dr.

Hilton
Chicago

E. 8th St.

E. 9th St.

E. 11th St.

E. Roosevelt Rd.



RUN IT BACK



BANK OF AMERICA



CHICAGO MARATHON®

20
27

APPLICATIONS OPEN
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8



chicagomarathon.com/apply



ABBOTT

tcs TATA
CONSULTANCY
SERVICES

Advocate
Health Care



BIOFREEZE



BANK OF AMERICA
CHICAGO DISTANCE SERIES

#ChicagoMarathon



ABBOTT
WORLD MARATHON MAJORS